The cadres of the Muslim Conference were getting very restive, particularly after Kak's sacking. There were daily demonstrations in Srinagar while the Maharaja installed Maj. Gen. Janak Singh as the new Prime Minister on 12 August 1947. Brig. Rajinder Singh was appointed the Chief of Staff on 24 September 1947. The Maharaja also relied on a trusted coterie of friends whom he used as a sounding board. This included Ram Lal Batra, who was made Deputy Prime Minister; Swami Sant Dev[2] who became the Maharaja's spiritual advisor and the Maharaja's close friend, Victor Rosenthal. These people were clearly inadequate for the task at hand. How would Jammu and Kashmir survive as an independent entity from 15 August 1947? When two trusted officers of that state are sacked because of their divided loyalties, days before a massive invasion of the state, what would be the level of anxiety and insecurity of the ruler?

The team of Janak Singh and Batra neither had the skill of Kak, nor did they have the kind of relationship with Scott and Powell that Kak enjoyed. The mere fact that both these British officers had assisted Kak in his aborted escape from Srinagar, confirms that despite being professionals, they could not have held the Janak Singh-Batra duo in the same esteem that they held Kak in. Therefore, from 12 August 1947, both Janak Singh and Batra were relatively ineffective in dealing with law and order, and external security.

Neither Nehru nor Jinnah had reached a decision on the prospect of the state of Jammu and Kashmir remaining in a state of limbo till the moment of the transfer of power. In fact, after the removal of Kak and the obvious mistrust towards both Scott and Powell, it became clear that the new, weakened political leadership of the state was ripe for exploitation.

The Standstill Agreements

During his June visit to the state, Mountbatten had suggested the need for the state to secure a Standstill Agreement with both India and Pakistan.[3] Such an agreement would enable the state to continue to enjoy the existing trade, communications and service arrangements it had enjoyed within